

Data Mining Dirty Data Homework

Homework: Dealing with dirty data. Submit to the myCourses dropbox. Due Sunday, June 2 to the myCourses dropbox.

I have a link to the data file to use for this assignment on the schedule page at ~tmh.

The data set contains around 30K entries and each instance has several attributes. Attributes are separated by commas, and each instance is on a separate line (it was created using Excel so it contains ^M unprintable EOL characters which you should ignore). It is not important that you know the meaning of each attribute for this assignment.

Your assignment is to clean this data set, specifically looking for missing or invalid data. For each suspected missing or invalid attribute you identify, list the following:

The line number

The instance in question

How you found the suspected problem

You may use any method you wish - Excel, write a program, or use an existing software tool. I encourage you to explore possible tools - data cleaning is very difficult to do without relying on tools!

I'm interested in two things:

1. That you find a successful strategy for identifying the invalid data.
2. That you are able to identify those instances that are in fact dirty.

Prepare a list of suspected dirty instances and bring a copy to use in our class discussion. Be prepared to describe your *approach* for cleaning the data.

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